Discuss and Possibly Adopt Revisions to Board Policy FM (Local)

Recommendation:
That the Board of Trustees adopt updated Local Board Policy FM (Local) Student Activities.

Explanation:
The Administration recommended revisions to Board Policy FM Student Activities. The Administration recommends that the updated Local Board Policy FM (Local) be adopted as presented.

Policy Reference: FM Local

Recommended by:

Dr. David Vinson
Superintendent of Schools

Extracurricular Activity Absences

The District shall make no distinction between absences for UIL activities and absences for other extracurricular activities approved by the Board. A student shall be allowed in a school year a maximum of ten extracurricular absences not related to post-district competition, a maximum of five absences for post-district competition prior to state, and a maximum of two absences for state competition.

Use of District Facilities

School-sponsored student groups may use District facilities with prior approval of the appropriate administrator. Other student groups may use District facilities in accordance with policy FNAB.

School Insignia

School mascots, colors, emblems, logos, and other insignia approved by the Board when a school campus is opened shall not be changed without the approval of the Superintendent. Schools shall adhere to these adopted items when ordering uniforms, materials, or publications for the school.

Participation in UIL Activities

In accordance with Texas Education Code 33.0834, and except as provided below, an interscholastic athletic team sponsored or authorized by the District may not allow a student to compete in an interscholastic athletic competition sponsored or authorized by the District that is designated for the biological sex opposite to the student's biological sex as correctly stated on:

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1. The student's official birth certificate; or
2. If the student's official birth certificate is unobtainable, another government-issued record.

Student Groups

District may authorize or sponsor a student group. Before a student may participate in a student group, the parent of or person standing in parental relation to a student enrolled in the District shall provide written consent for participation.

Prohibitions

The District shall not authorize or sponsor a student group based on sexual orientation or gender identity as defined in EMB (Local).

Student groups shall not violate the prohibition on certain topics found in Board Policies EFA (Local), EFB (Local), EMB (Local) and EMI (Local).

Holidays or Commemorative Months

If the club wants to acknowledge the significance of a federal or state holiday or commemorative month, consistent with Education Code 11.005(e)(2) and EMB (Local), the club acknowledgment should generally meet a three-prong test:

1. It should acknowledge the significance of a federal or state holiday or commemorative month (established through a Presidential Proclamation, Congressional law or Resolution, Gubernatorial Proclamation, or Texas legislative law or Resolution);
2. It should acknowledge how the holiday or month fits into the themes of history and the stories of this state and the United States of America; and
3. It should be consistent with the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS).